HOW TECH MOVES

See how technology actually works.

How Tech Moves — 10 Cinematic Video Concepts

Premium visual explainers for Reels, Shorts and TikTok

A production brief for the brand's next tier of visual explainers.

AI · SOFTWARE · NETWORKING · HARDWARE · INTERNET · CYBERSECURITY · CLOUD

howtechmoves.com · @howtechmoves

Why these ten

The brief

How Tech Moves makes technology understandable, one visual at a time. The short explainers already on the site run 12–42 seconds and cover AI, software, networking, hardware, internet, cybersecurity and cloud. This document is the next tier up: ten concepts built for a cinematic treatment — real depth, real lighting, real motion — so the brand can hold attention on a feed that is already saturated with talking heads.

How to read each concept

Every concept carries a logline, the reason it earns a slot, a numbered shot sequence, the on-screen text, a sound direction and the call to action. Runtimes are targets for a 9:16 vertical cut; the same shoot list works for a 16:9 long-form version.

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01 How Packets Find Their Way — Internet, 45–60s

02 How a CPU Thinks, Cycle by Cycle — Hardware, 30–45s

03 How AI Writes, One Token at a Time — AI, 40–50s

04 How Your Data Crosses the Ocean — Internet, 45–60s

05 How Encryption Locks a Message — Cybersecurity, 35–45s

06 How the Cloud Survives a Server Dying — Cloud, 40–55s

07 How a Bloom Filter Knows Without Looking — Software, 35–45s

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10 APIs vs MCP: How AI Reaches Your Tools — AI, 45–60s

CONCEPT 01 · INTERNET

How Packets Find Their Way

Runtime	45–60s	**Format**	Reel + Short, 9:16, macro-to-global

LOGLINE

Follow a single packet from the keystroke to the far side of the planet — and show the routers that quietly argue over which road to take.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

Everyone uses the internet; almost nobody has watched a packet travel. It is the brand's most universal topic and the easiest to make genuinely cinematic.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 Extreme macro: a fingertip lands. The key depresses, spring compresses, contacts close. Sound design is a single deep thud.

02 Cut inside the machine: a burst of light leaves the network card and races down a lit fibre channel.

03 Pull back through the router. Show it dropping the packet into a queue, then re-reading the address like a postal worker scanning a label.

04 Long dolly across a map made of light — several possible paths drawn in pale cyan, only one igniting as the packet commits.

05 Land on the destination data centre: row after row of racks, one tiny indicator blinking.

06 Final beat: the page renders on the far screen, half a world away, in time with the original keystroke's echo.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“A packet is not a thing. It is a decision.” · “Every hop is a choice.” · “Round trip: 140ms.”

SOUND

Minimal pulse, one percussive hit per hop. No music under the macro beats.

CTA Watch the full explainer at howtechmoves.com

CONCEPT 02 · HARDWARE

How a CPU Thinks, Cycle by Cycle

Runtime	30–45s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, macro silicon

LOGLINE

Open the chip. Let the clock be the edit — every beat of the film is one tick of the processor.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

The 12-second CPU explainer already performs. A cinematic version trades speed for awe: the chip becomes architecture, not a diagram.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 Black frame. One heartbeat. Then the die opens like a city seen from the air at night.

02 Macro over the silicon surface: thousands of traces, lit in cyan, running in parallel.

03 Freeze the frame on a single trace and follow one instruction as it arrives.

04 The clock ticks — a metronome in the score — and the frame advances one step. Repeat four times, each tick visually different.

05 Slow pull-out as the whole die synchronises, every trace pulsing on the same beat.

06 Cut to the finished action on screen: a tap opens an app instantly.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“Fetch. Decode. Execute. Repeat.” · “3 billion times a second.” · “The clock is the edit.”

SOUND

A metronome that slowly becomes the bassline.

CTA Full breakdown on howtechmoves.com

CONCEPT 03 · AI

How AI Writes, One Token at a Time

Runtime	40–50s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, text-led motion

LOGLINE

The chatbot is not thinking of a sentence. It is choosing the next word, over and over, faster than you can read.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

This is the site's signature idea — 'How AI chatbots write word by word'. A cinematic cut makes the mechanism feel physical rather than abstract.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 A blank page in a dark room. One word appears, alone: 'The'.

02 Camera pushes in as a constellation of candidate words lights up around it. Each one has a faint weight beneath it.

03 The heaviest candidate rises and locks into place. The others fade.

04 Repeat accelerated: word follows word, the constellation rebuilding each time, faster and faster until it is a blur.

05 Hard cut to silence: the finished paragraph, complete, sitting still on the page.

06 Final push-in as a single word in the paragraph subtly glows.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“It is not writing. It is choosing.” · “Next word. Then the next.” · “Every word is a fork in the road.”

SOUND

Rising arpeggio per token; total silence on the reveal.

CTA See the 14-second explainer on the site

CONCEPT 04 · INTERNET

How Your Data Crosses the Ocean

Runtime	45–60s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, scale contrast

LOGLINE

Ninety-nine percent of the internet is not in the sky. It is lying on the ocean floor, in cables the width of a garden hose.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

The undersea cable explainer is inherently visual and underexplained. Scale contrast — satellite dish versus a hair-thin strand — is pure cinema.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 Open on a satellite dish against a pale sky. Everyone assumes this is the internet.

02 Whip pan down, through cloud, through water surface, into black.

03 Descend alongside a cable — a thin, unremarkable line vanishing into darkness.

04 Reveal the scale: a repeater housing, the size of a van, energised on the sea floor with a low hum of light.

05 Cross-section animation: glass core, light bouncing at a shallow angle through thousands of kilometres.

06 Surfacing shot: the cable makes landfall and disappears into a grey building. Cut to your phone loading a page.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“99% of the internet is underwater.” · “It is glass. It is light.” · “A hose, not a pipe.”

SOUND

Muffled hydrophone ambience, then a clean glassy tone on surfacing.

CTA Full explainer on howtechmoves.com

CONCEPT 05 · CYBERSECURITY

How Encryption Locks a Message

Runtime	35–45s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, practical effects

LOGLINE

One key anyone can hold, one key only you keep. The message protects itself in the crossing.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

Security content usually explains this with padlocks and jargon. Doing it with physical mechanics — real metal, real light — makes it memorable and shareable.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 A message is written on paper and sealed in a metal case. The camera orbits it.

02 An open lock is shown to the viewer — bright, obvious, public. Anyone could hold this.

03 The case snaps shut. The keyhole seals with a bright closing iris.

04 The case travels: handed through a crowd of anonymous silhouettes, each one trying the public key and failing.

05 It arrives. One hand produces the other key, dark and unworn. The case opens in a bloom of light.

06 Cut to a phone: an end-to-end encrypted chat bubble arriving with a tick.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“Two keys, not one.” · “Public locks it. Private opens it.” · “You hold the only one that works.”

SOUND

Metallic clicks and one deep sub hit on the seal.

CTA Watch the VPN explainer next

CONCEPT 06 · CLOUD

How the Cloud Survives a Server Dying

Runtime	40–55s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, one-take feel

LOGLINE

The cloud is just other people's computers — until one of them dies mid-sentence and you never notice.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

Trust content. It answers an unspoken fear and quietly explains redundancy, load balancing and replication in one visual sweep.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 A data centre aisle, symmetrical, fans roaring. Steadicam walks the row.

02 One rack's lights die. Audibly. The fan noise drops a note.

03 No cut. The camera keeps moving as traffic visibly reroutes — thin light streams bending to neighbouring racks like water finding a new channel.

04 The dead rack is carried out past the camera by two technicians, matter-of-factly.

05 Overhead: the same page loading on three phones around the world, all smooth.

06 Final frame: the empty slot, still powered, waiting for the replacement.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“The cloud is other people's computers.” · “One died. Nothing noticed.” · “Copies, not backups.”

SOUND

Continuous room tone — drop it out for one beat when the rack dies.

CTA More on how the cloud works at howtechmoves.com

CONCEPT 07 · SOFTWARE

How a Bloom Filter Knows Without Looking

Runtime 35–45s **Format** Reel, 9:16, negative space

LOGLINE

It answers one question instantly: have I seen this before? It is allowed to be wrong — just never wrongly reassuring.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

A cult-favourite explainer. Cinematically it is the brand's most distinctive piece: a film about absence, false positives and elegant constraints.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 An immense dark library of books. A librarian is asked: is this book here?

02 The librarian does not search. Instead, three small lamps on the desk are checked.

03 Show the mechanic: each arrival flips a few lamps on. Nothing is ever switched off.

04 A book arrives that is not in the library. All three lamps happen to be lit. The librarian says yes — and is wrong.

05 Reverse shot: a book that IS present, two lamps lit, answer confidently yes.

06 Hold on the lamps, never switched off. The flaw is the design.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“It never says no by accident.” · “Small. Fast. Slightly wrong.” · “No means no. Yes means maybe.”

SOUND

Library quiet; each lamp tick is a dry click.

CTA The 42-second explainer is on the site

CONCEPT 08 · NETWORKING

How Wi-Fi Turns Radio Into Words

Runtime	25–35s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, invisible made visible

LOGLINE

There is no cable. There is a wave, shaking with meaning, passing through the wall you are leaning on.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

High-frequency content — people understand it instantly and it reads beautifully as pure visual effects. Strong hook potential.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 A router, alone in a dark room. One light pulses.

02 The pulse leaves and becomes a wave — you can see it now, rippling outward in concentric forms.

03 The wave passes through a wall; the film goes briefly to cross-section, drywall and paint and wire rendered in silhouette.

04 Inside the wave, the data is shown as a changing shape — the modulation — riding the ripple.

05 It reaches a laptop antenna and collapses into a single bright point that resolves into the waveform of a song starting.

06 Cut to the song playing on the device, normal, unremarkable.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“No cable. Just a wave.” · “Data rides on the shape of the ripple.” · “Wi-Fi is radio with manners.”

SOUND

Silence, then the sound of the wave as a whoosh, resolving into the song.

CTA Subscribe for one explainer a week

CONCEPT 09 · SOFTWARE

How Code Becomes an App on Your Phone

Runtime	35–45s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, transform montage

LOGLINE

Ten thousand lines of text, squeezed through a compiler, and they come out as something you can tap.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

A builder story. It flatters the audience and demystifies the tooling, and it is a natural place to show the brand's own craft.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 A monitor full of source code, badly lit, scrolling.

02 A machine takes it in — the compiler as a physical press. Plates close.

03 Inside: the code being reduced, deduplicated, minified, until it is a compact payload no human could read.

04 The payload is transmitted as a bright thread to a hand holding a phone.

05 The phone screen assembles itself in layers, bit by bit, ending on a recognisable app interface.

06 The user's thumb taps an icon — and the film cuts back to the first line of source code, still on screen.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“Text in. Something tappable out.” · “Your phone never sees the source.” · “A compiler is a translation, not a copy.”

SOUND

Mechanical press, then a clean chime on the tap.

CTA Full explainer at howtechmoves.com

CONCEPT 10 · AI

APIs vs MCP: How AI Reaches Your Tools

Runtime	45–60s	**Format**	Reel, 9:16, dual-track comparison

LOGLINE

An API is one door. MCP is a keyring. That difference is why your AI assistant can suddenly read your calendar.

WHY IT EARNS A SLOT

The most forward-looking concept in the set. It explains the shift everyone is hearing about, and positions the brand as ahead of the conversation.

SHOT SEQUENCE

01 Split screen, equal weight: left is an API, right is MCP. Both start dark.

02 Left: a single door. The AI knocks. A human has to hold it open for every request — shown as repeated, tired arm movements.

03 Right: a keyring of many keys, handed over once, under explicit terms.

04 The AI on the right moves between rooms — calendar, mail, database — each door opening cleanly, with a permission label visible on each.

05 Cut to a real task completing end to end on a laptop, unattended.

06 Final beat: the keyring, and a small lock icon, closing the loop on consent.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

“One door, or a set of keys.” · “MCP does not remove permissions.” · “Tools, not magic.”

SOUND

Two competing rhythms that merge into one clean beat.

CTA Read the topic guide on the site